



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

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Introduction

This procedure describes the selection, the training, the specification of the responsibilities and authorities and the evaluation of the effects of training of the personnel of BFAR RFL XII according to the requirements of the par. 6.2 of the PNS ISO/IEC 17025:2017.

1. Responsibilities

- Regional Director of BFAR RFL XII
- Laboratory Manager
- Quality Assurance Manager

2. Skills and Qualifications of Personnel

2.1. The skills and the qualifications of the technical personnel of BFAR RFL XII are specified by the regulations applied to the operation of BFAR. Recruitment of permanent personnel is carried out according to this legislation.

2.2. Employment of non-permanent staff is possible. However, any such relation of employment shall be under contract and according to the respective rules of the legislation applied to BFAR.

3. Internal Training of New Personnel

3.1. Every new employee, upon his recruitment in BFAR RFL XII is fully informed of the rules and the regulations of BFAR RFL XII related to the personnel, LF 01-02 (Orientation on Laboratory Safety). Similar information is provided to staff under contract. The purpose of this training is each new employee to be fully aware of the regulations applied to BFAR RFL XII.

3.2. The Quality Assurance Manager is responsible to provide training to any new employee (permanent and non-permanent) on issues of the quality management system. All new employees shall be aware of the structure, the documents of the quality management system and their use. Special emphasis is given on issues of confidentiality, transparency, integrity and independence. Each employee shall sign a declaration form (LF 01-01) for confidentiality, impartiality, independence and integrity. Copies of this form are held in a record by the Quality Assurance Manager. The purpose of this training is for each new employee to be familiar with

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the use of the elements of the quality management system in the area of his work and fully aware of the rules for confidentiality, impartiality, independence and integrity.

3.3. The immediate superior of the new employee is responsible to provide training in the area of responsibility. The training provided by the Supervisors of the Laboratory sections may include:

- study of test methods, standards and manufacturers' manuals under the instruction of the respective supervisor or other authorized qualified technical personnel
- presence in test methods and other laboratory activities carried-out by qualified staff

3.4. The immediate superior is responsible to evaluate the readiness of the new employee, LF 01-06 (Personnel Competence Assessment) to undertake full responsibilities of his work and to specify the area of these responsibilities.

4. Internal Training of Existing Personnel

4.1. Existing personnel of BFAR RFL XII is trained on a continuous basis to improve their professional and technical capabilities. In this respect, the training includes issues:

Group A: Related to the management and the handling of the quality management system, such as, use of forms and procedures, internal audits, organizing records, **implementing corrective actions**, risk-based thinking, to improve the degree of the quality management system implementation and/or to implement modifications of the quality management system elements

Group B: Related to subjects of general and specific interest, such as applications and developments of software, safety, implementation of new rules and regulations relevant to the operation of BFAR RFL XII.

Group C: Of technical nature of Test Methods and relevant subjects.

4.2. A general plan for training is drawn each year according to the needs as specified by the head of each unit. The main source to define the training needs of the personnel is the Annual Report according to LF 19-01 and the proposals submitted to the management review.

4.3. Individual training classified at any of the above groups A, B, C, may be requested and performed at any time of the year independently of the training plan in cases such as:

- Installation and use of new equipment
- Implementation of new procedures

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- Application of new methods
- Implementation of corrective actions
- Announcement of special activities and results, i.e. from meetings, conferences, projects, etc, of general interest, which contribute to improvement of knowledge and competence

5. External Training

5.1. External training is considered any training provided by an external party, such as manufacturers, suppliers, experts in the facilities of BFAR RFL XII and other affiliated agencies.

5.2. External training is provided to new and existing personnel upon approval by the Regional Director of BFAR RFL XII and includes the subjects of par.3 and 4 of this procedure.

6. Responsibilities and Authorities

6.1. The responsibilities of the personnel are described within in each procedure, providing their range and limits. However, if additional responsibilities and tasks are assigned to the staff, a job description is issued for each employee according to SOP-01, Responsibilities and Authorities of Personnel.

6.2. Especially for the technical personnel working in the laboratory units, as soon as an employee is assessed as technically competent upon completing his required training (par. 3, 4), he is authorized to carry out technical work (test methods and analysis) and have access to the relevant equipment.

6.3. The List of Authorized Personnel LF 01-05, contains:

- The name and the respective position of each authorized employee
- References of the technical fields of test methods and analyses covered by the authorization

7. Recording and Evaluation of Training

7.1. All information regarding the training, i.e., subject, duration, time, place, type (internal/external) and group (A, B, C) are found and recorded in the Personal Data Sheet (PDS) of the individual employee.

7.2. All recorded information of training are processed once a year to determine results with respect to the volume of training and its contribution to groups and types of training.

7.3. Trainings will be evaluated by the personnel who had undergone training through the LF 01-08, Training Impact Evaluation Form. This will be assessed by the immediate superior and approved by the Laboratory Manager.

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8. Supervision and Authorization of Personnel

8.1. The newly hired or designated personnel will be taught and supervised by the technical manager or immediate supervisor.

8.2. The performance expectations are set as defined in the LF 01-06, Personnel Competence Assessment where skills necessary for the quality performance of the specific job are listed.

8.3. Laboratory activities performed by the personnel-on-training are supervised and assessed by the immediate superior.

8.4. If the expected level of competence is achieved, then the personnel-on-training is authorized to access the relevant equipment and perform the test.

9. Determining and Monitoring Competence of Personnel

9.1. Targets are set twice a year by the laboratory to determine competence through the Individual Performance Commitment and Review Form. Frequency for determining competence is done twice a year.

9.2. Determining and evaluating competency of personnel can be found in SOP 01-10.

9.3. Personnel also undergo training in order to improve competence.

10. Forms

CSC Form 212 Revised 2017, Personal Data Sheet

CSC Form 06 Series of 2012, Individual Performance Commitment and Review Form

Fisheries Office Order Series of 20XX

LF 01-01, Declaration Form

LF 01-02, Orientation on Laboratory Safety

LF 01-05, List of Authorized Personnel

LF 01-06, Personnel Competence Assessment

LF 19-01, Annual Quality Report

External Training Plan

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11. Document History

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